

Konami®

SHAOLIN'S ROAD™

The background illustration features several characters in a dynamic martial arts setting. In the foreground, a man with a mustache in a white sleeveless shirt is shown from the chest up, with his fists clenched. Behind him, a man in a yellow and red robe holds two swords. To the right, a woman in a pink qipao is in a kicking pose. Above them, another character in blue is jumping. The scene is set against a backdrop of traditional Chinese architecture, all framed by a yellow border with a red Greek key pattern.

MSX

V9990

USER MANUAL

The MSX game on the V9990

SHAO-LIN'S ROAD

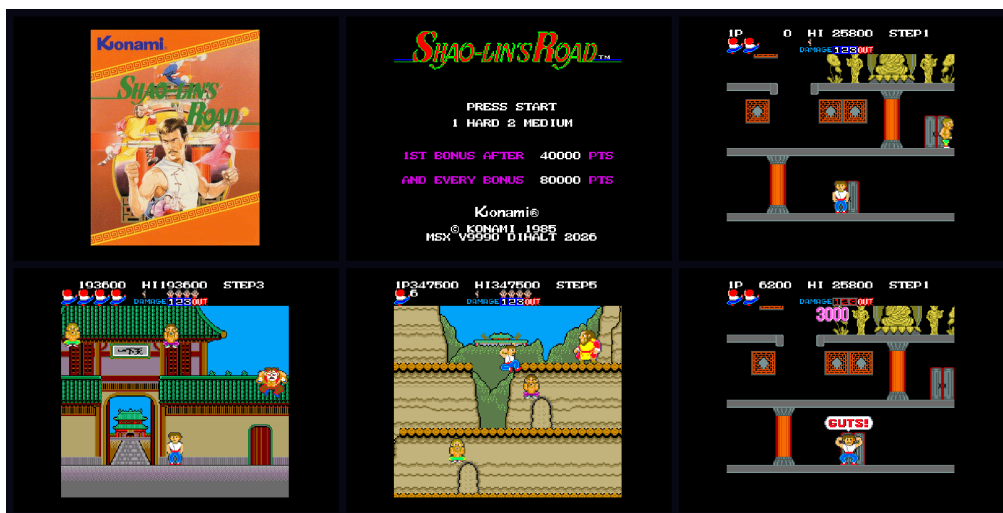
for the Yamaha V9990



V9990

An original game by **Konami**, 1985.

V9990 port by **DiHalt Studio**, 2026.



This is an unofficial port made for study, preservation, and homage.

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1. What you need



Figure 1: The Yamaha V9990 video processor, the chip this version of the game draws with. Photo: Yaca2671, Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA 3.0.

Item	Requirement
Computer	Any MSX1 with two cartridge slots, one for the game and one for the V9990. Tested on a Sony HB-10P (MSX1) and on an MSX turbo R; other MSX generations should work but have not been tested.
Memory	64 KB of RAM in the main memory (all four pages).
Video	A V9990 cartridge (Yamaha V9990 video). It is mandatory: the whole picture is drawn by the V9990. The computer's own video chip is kept blank on purpose.
Sound	The MSX PSG is always used. An SCC (in the game cartridge or in another slot) is optional.
Game	The Shao-lin's Road V9990 cartridge : a 1 MiB Konami SCC MegaROM (the file <code>shaolins_v9990.rom</code> , written to a flash cartridge or equivalent).
Monitor	A monitor or TV connected to the V9990's video output , not to the MSX's own video output.
Controls	Keyboard, cursor keys, or a joystick in port 1.

No tape, no disk, no password. The whole game is in the cartridge.

2. Setting up

1. **Switch the MSX off.** Never insert or remove a cartridge with the power on.
2. Insert the **V9990 cartridge** in one of the cartridge slots.
3. Insert the **Shao-lin's Road cartridge** in the other slot. The order does not matter.
4. Connect your monitor or TV to the **video output of the V9990**.
5. Plug a joystick into port 1 if you want to use one.
6. Switch the MSX on. For a moment the MSX's own screen shows V9990 found !; then the picture appears on the V9990's monitor. If it says V9990 NOT found!!! the V9990 is missing

or not seated, and the game stops there.

If the screen stays black check, in this order: the monitor is on the V9990's output; the V9990 and the game are fully inserted; the computer has 64 KB of RAM; the game ROM is the 1 MiB Konami SCC MegaROM build. On an emulator such as openMSX, enable the V9990 extension and load the ROM with the right mapper.

3. From power-on to the game



Figure 2: Left: the cover. Right: the title screen.

1. **Start-up message.** On the MSX's own screen, KONAMI 1985 / DIHALT STUDIO 2026 / V9990 found ! for two seconds.
2. **DiHalt logo.** Shown for four seconds; it cannot be skipped.
3. **Cover.** The full-screen illustration. Press any key or any joystick direction or button to continue (it also goes on by itself after ten seconds).
4. **Title screen.** PRESS START, 1 HARD 2 MEDIUM and the extra-life information. Press **1**, **SPACE** or the joystick button **A** to start in **hard** mode, or **2** or the joystick button **B** to start in **medium** mode. If you wait, the game plays a demonstration and shows the high-score table, then returns to the title.
5. **The game:** five stages, then the same five again, a little harder, and so on.

When you lose your last life the game shows GAME OVER. If your score is among the best eight you enter your three initials; then the title screen comes back.

4. Controls

The controls are those of the arcade. The keyboard, the cursor keys and joystick 1 work at the same time.

Action	Keyboard	Joystick
Move left / right	← →	stick left / right
Up: jump to the floor above	↑	stick up
Down: drop to the floor below	↓	stick down
Kick	SPACE or Z	button A
Jump	M or X	button B
Start, hard mode (title screen)	1, SPACE	button A
Start, medium mode (title screen)	2	button B
Letters of your initials	← →, kick to accept	stick, button A

Notes.

- The stick behaves like the arcade lever. If you reverse direction without passing through the centre, the game gives the stick one neutral frame so that the hero turns round instead of walking backwards.
- Kick while you jump to land a *jump kick*, worth more points.
- **SPACE**, button A and button B start the game only from the title screen and the demo. During the game, and when you enter your initials, they only kick and jump.
- The two modes are one-player games. **Hard** is the arcade's tough setting; **medium** gives the enemies less speed and aggression, and still gets harder with every stage.
- There is no pause key and no reset key, as in the arcade.

5. How to play

You are a kung-fu fighter fighting through five stages, from the temple hall to a mountain pass. Each stage has several floors: go up with , drop down with . On every stage the same plan applies:

1. **Beat the 21 enemies** that come out of the two doors and from the sides. Kick them down; a jump kick scores more.
2. When the last of the wave is down, the **boss** of the stage appears. Hit it **five times** to beat it.
3. Beat the boss and the stage is clear: your **GUTS!** bonus is counted and the next **STEP** begins.

After the fifth stage the game starts again from the first, with faster and more aggressive enemies. From the second round on, a **bird** flies over the stage now and then and **drops a rock**: step aside.

Some enemies carry a **power-up ball**. Knock down the carrier to get a special weapon for a while.

Each stage has a time limit. When little time is left a **HURRY UP** banner appears, and when it runs out you lose a life (**TIME OVER**). The more enemies there are to beat, the more time you are given.

6. The status panel (HUD)

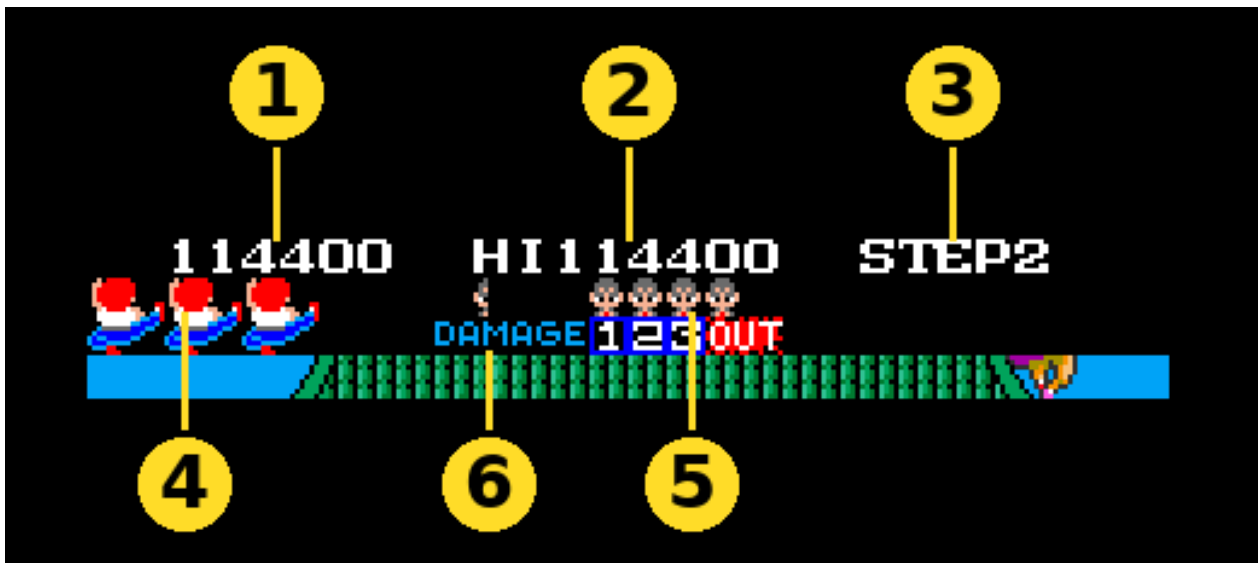


Figure 3: The status panel at the top of the screen.

No.	Element	What it tells you
1	Score	Your score.
2	High score	The best score of the high-score table.
3	Stage	STEP and the number of the stage, counting the rounds (after the fifth stage comes STEP 6).
4	Lives	One icon for each spare life; with five or more it shows one icon and the number.
5	Enemies left	Each small head stands for three enemies still to beat in the wave; it shortens as you win.
6	Damage	DAMAGE 1 2 3 OUT: each hit lights one more number, and the current one blinks. The fourth hit, OUT, costs a life.

7. Scoring and lives

Action	Points
Kick an enemy	200
Jump kick	500
Combo (second knock-out in quick succession)	1000
Make the bonus object appear	500
GUTS! bonus, for each unused damage level	1000

- You start with **3 lives**.
- You earn an **extra life at 40 000 points and then every 80 000**.
- The difficulty is the one you choose at the title screen, **hard** (1) or **medium** (2), and grows with every stage you clear.
- After GAME OVER, the eight best scores are kept in the **high-score table**, with your three initials: change the letter with left and right, and kick to accept it. The table starts with the names MSX, BTV, DI, HLT, KON and AMI.



Figure 4: Left: the GUTS! bonus at the end of a stage. Right: the high-score table.

8. Tips

- Keep moving: enemies surround you. Fight with your back to a wall or a door only when you have room to retreat.
- A kick has a short reach. Let the enemy come close and kick as it arrives.
- The jump kick scores 500 against 200 for a kick and crosses gaps, but leaves you exposed while you are in the air.
- Use up and down to change floor, and look at which enemies wait on the floor you are heading for.
- Keep your damage low: every level you do not use is worth **1000 points** when the stage is clear.
- Watch the head icons: when only a few are left, the boss is close.
- From the second round on, look up when you hear the bird.
- Always read the time: with HURRY UP on screen, go straight for the remaining enemies.

9. Credits and rights

- **Shao-lin's Road** is a game by **Konami**, 1985. The game, its graphics, music and name belong to their rights holders. This is an unofficial port made for study, preservation and homage; it is not affiliated with them.
- **V9990 version** (display engine, tools, title screen, cover conversion): **DiHalt Studio**, 2026.
- MSX is a trademark of MSX Licensing Corporation. The MSX logo is shown only to say which computers the game runs on (file MSX-Logo.svg, Wikimedia Commons).
- V9990 is the name of the Yamaha video chip; the chip photo is by Yaca2671, CC BY-SA 3.0.
- Source code available on GitHub. **Please improve the game if you feel so!**

Appendix. Cartridge label

A label for the cartridge, ready to print. At 100 % it is about 16 cm wide; scale it in your printing program to fit the label area of your cartridge (the artwork has a 3:2 proportion).

